legitimate political form'. The difficulty here is that '[t]his premise subverts the laborious work of generations who fought to end empire on the grounds that it was illegitimate – the imposition of racist, violent, and extractive form of rule'. Prof. Satia makes an important comparison which has never been made in the same manner before, namely, that '[h]istorical evaluation of racist despotisms in Europe – for instance, fascist regimes – are never written about as legitimate, and yet many write about empire as though it can be evaluated neutrally'. Driving her point home, she refers to the absurd irony of how '[n]o historian would say, yes, Hitler was horrible to the Jews, but, on the other hand, he built the autobahn!'[14] In this sense, historical adjustment is political. What is needed is political redress, or at least political acknowledgement, but otherwise apologies mean little or nothing. The wrong done to Bhagat Singh and his comrades, in the sense of putting them before a Tribunal, the sole purpose of which was to hang them speedily is arguably one that requires a political adjustment.

In fact, if the imperial project was conceived as a 'civilising mission' against an uncivilized people, as many such as Kim Wagner have argued, then at one level it is surely impossible to ask an apology of someone who did not believe that what he was doing was wrong at all. For such a person, those who refused to be 'civilised' in this manner, as Bhagat Singh and many others did during the Raj, were met with 'divine retribution' rooted deeply in a fundamentalist Christian tradition. The setting up of a special tribunal was deliberate. It was a way of inflicting such 'divine retribution' on those who stepped out of line. It was eminently visible for all to see and learn from. Its 'justice' was exalted and celebrated by the colonizer. It was not something to be ashamed of. That is why it was not hidden. That is also why trial by special tribunal was not such an anomaly as appears at first sight but used frequently as a means of dispensing 'colonial justice'. An apology can only be demanded of someone who recognizes what they are doing to be wrong. In this case, there was no such recognition, and indeed, very little of the same in the following decades. In one sense, therefore, it is arguable that it is far more important to remember the verdicts of the past, right and wrong, rather than to try to expunge them. An attempt to expunge